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EVALUATE · TRAIN · BUILD

The **Art** of Hiring

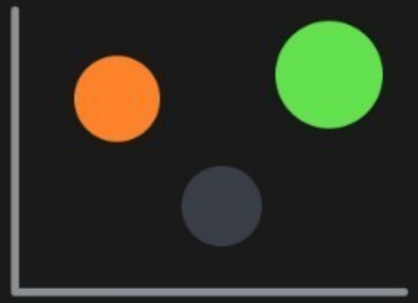
- Evaluating candidates [30 MIN]
- Training interviewers [30 MIN]
- Building the process [30 MIN]

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Three arcs.
One team of A players.

01 · EVALUATE

Strength × Fit



Who should we hire?

02 · TRAIN

Five levels



What makes an interviewer great?

03 · BUILD

3-stage process

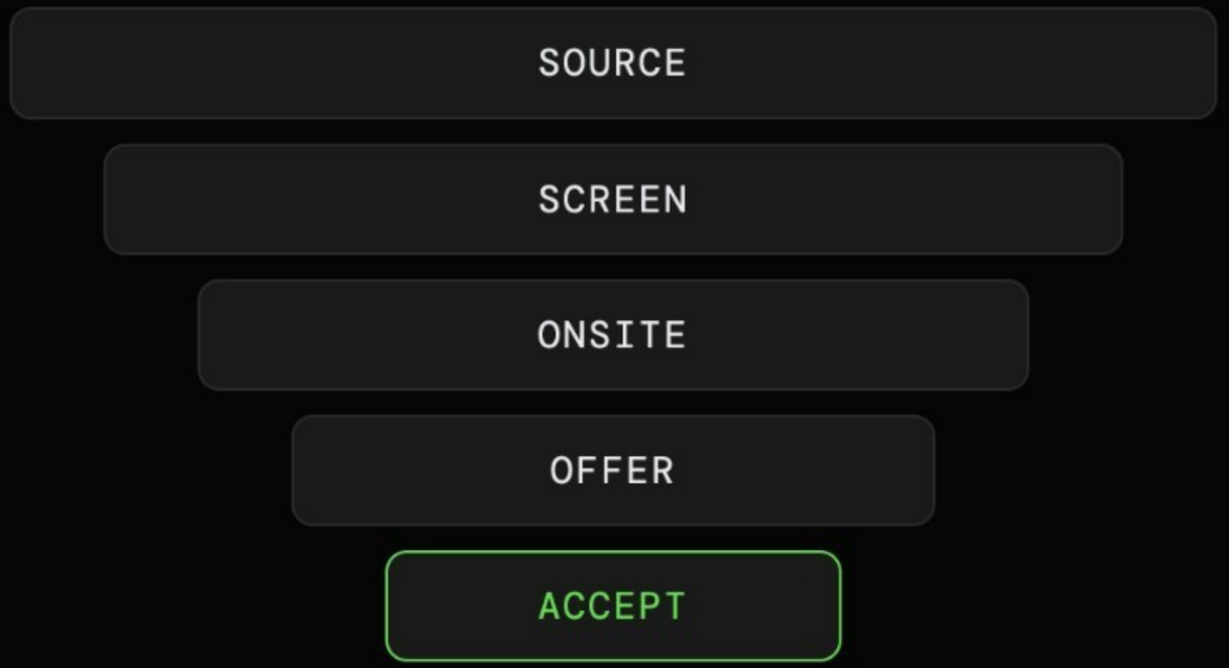


How do we run it?

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Hiring is a sales funnel.



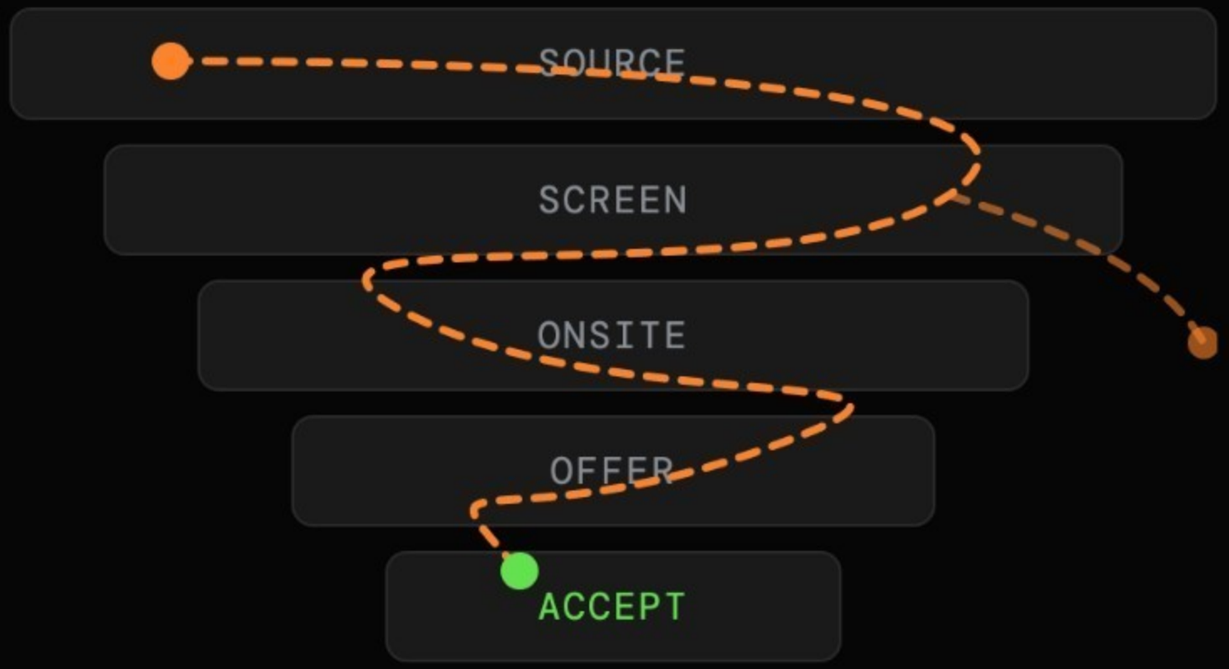
Every stage converts…

…or leaks.

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...but nobody moves through it in a line.



BOUNCE

Candidates skip ahead, stall for weeks, and drop out at every stage.

FALSE NEGATIVES / POSITIVES

Candidates might need to go **backwards** to avoid mishiring... or missing out on a great person.

TIME IS A FRIENDLY FOE

Isn't it crazy that we make decisions that affect us for years after just a few hours with the team? We are all busy, so we optimize for less time here... often wrongly. Don't be afraid to **increase** time in each stage so a candidate feels valued, comfortable, and familiar with us.

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Every part of the funnel is a different filter.

SOURCE → Are they on the market?

RECRUITER SCREEN → Would they ever even choose us?

EM SCREEN → Will they be excited about us?

TECH SCREEN → Are they likely to be a good engineer?

ONSITE → Are they a **GREAT** engineer?
→ Will they thrive at Mashgin?

OFFER → Will they choose **US** over the competition?



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But it's also matchmaking!
Why would they choose US?

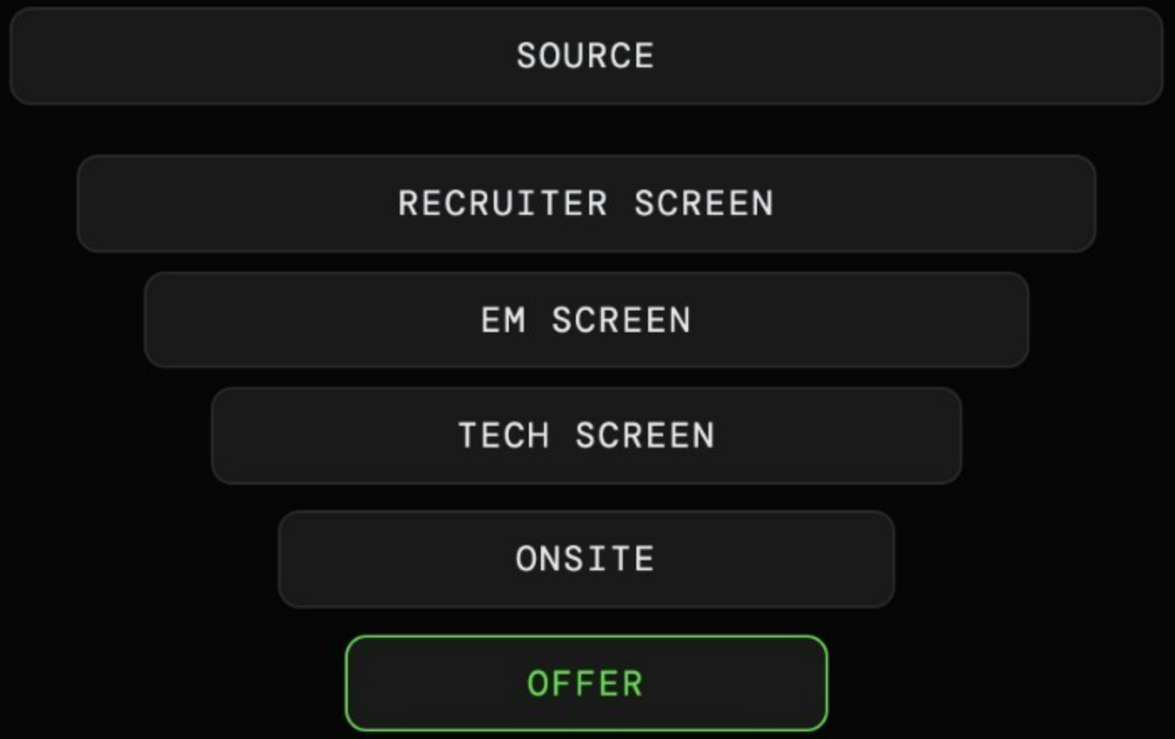


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[THE OTHER DIRECTION]

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How are they judging US?



← Does Mashgin seem like an interesting company / problem / technology / team / whatever I care about…?

← Who are these people? What is their “culture”?

← Would I want to work for this person?

← Are these engineers sharp?

← Will I learn from these people?
← Will I grow here?

← Is this the best bet for my career?

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Strength × Fit



We want **top-right** candidates.

Candidates want **top-right** companies.

Neither side ever defines it. Both choose on “vibes.”

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Defining “Strength”: A, B, C, D players

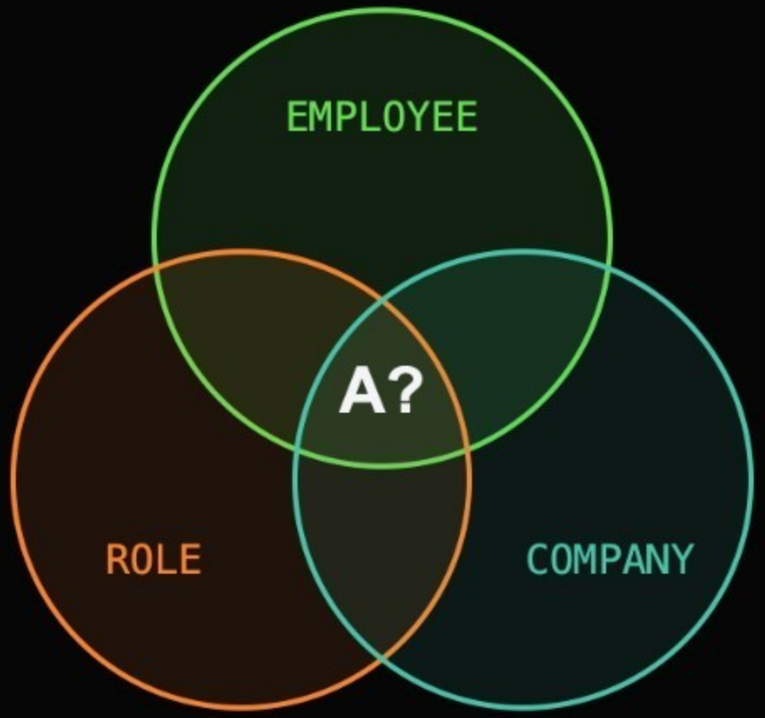
A	B	C	D
90% likely to solve the problems you throw at them.	**75%** likely to solve the problems you throw at them.	**60%** likely to **FAIL**. Why risk it?	Lowers team productivity, drives away key talent, degrades the codebase.
HOW THEY AFFECT OTHERS ↓			
Attracts other A players.	Can irritate A players.	Drives away A players.	**Gets you fired.**

* Depends on the role → an A player in one role might be a D player in another!

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Would they be an A player here?



EMPLOYEE

Skill / Will “vector”

ROLE

Too big
Too small
Not interesting

“Goldilocks problem”

COMPANY

Culture: “the unspoken rules”

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Anyone can get lucky.
A players bat with consistency.

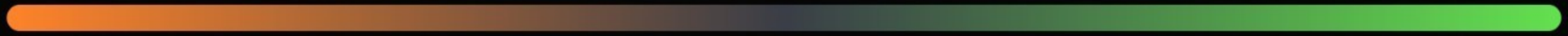


Look for a track record of winning, not just one home run.

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Defining “Fit”: −10 to +10



−10 · UNALIGNED	0	+10 · ALIGNED
Mercenary	**Ambivalent**	**Missionary**
Here for what they can extract.	Could go either way.	Wants what we want.

Do they want what we need, and do we offer what they want? Both directions.

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Mercenary

fixed mindset | defending | me | extrinsics | activity | similar | logarithmic growth | participant | apathetic | potential | victim | job | watch | debate

IN ENGINEERS

résumé-driven development | title-chaser | counting to the vesting cliff | comp before the problem | "not my job" | ticket-taker

AT MASHGIN

cargo-culting | offer-shopping | hotness-chaser

VIBE CHECK: "Pay me."

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Missionary

growth mindset | learning | we | intrinsics | impact | diverse | exponential growth | owner | empathetic | accomplished | determined | career | engage

AT MASHGIN · ASK THE ROOM

? ? ? ? ?

VIBE CHECK: “Grow me.”

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Missionary

growth mindset | learning | we | intrinsics | impact | diverse | exponential growth

owner | empathetic | accomplished | determined | career | engage

AT MASHGIN

scrappy | loves hardware | efficiency | first principles | build, don't buy

VIBE CHECK: “Grow me.”

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Why is fit SO important — at a STARTUP?

	RISK	CONVERSION	MASLOW MOTIVATION
BIG TECH	Lots of teams. Can switch if needed.	OK being a small part of something **BIG**.	Wants $ / Esteem
MASHGIN	Must fit on **THIS** team, otherwise fired.	Wants to be the **HERO** in their thing.	Seeking Self-Actualization

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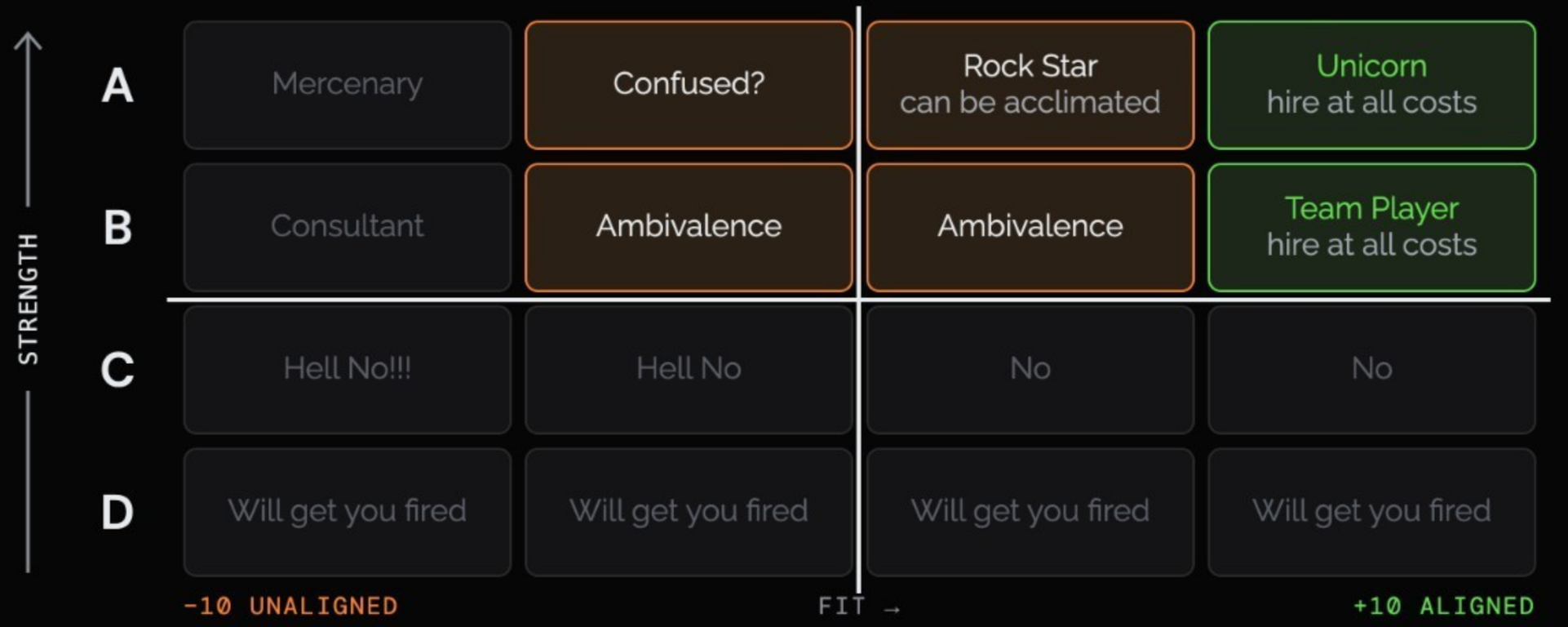
Strength × Fit



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The area of confusion.



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Resolve it, or coach it.



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Give them some pain.

CHALLENGE

World View



MAKE IT REAL

Lower Pay



COLD SPLASH

Title Shrink



How they react tells you how they think about the role. (You can always walk it back later.)

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Was it THEM, or their environment?

RE-INTERVIEW

Missed Strengths



LACKED OPPORTUNITY

Challenging Onboarding



WRONG MENTORSHIP

Pair with Your Best

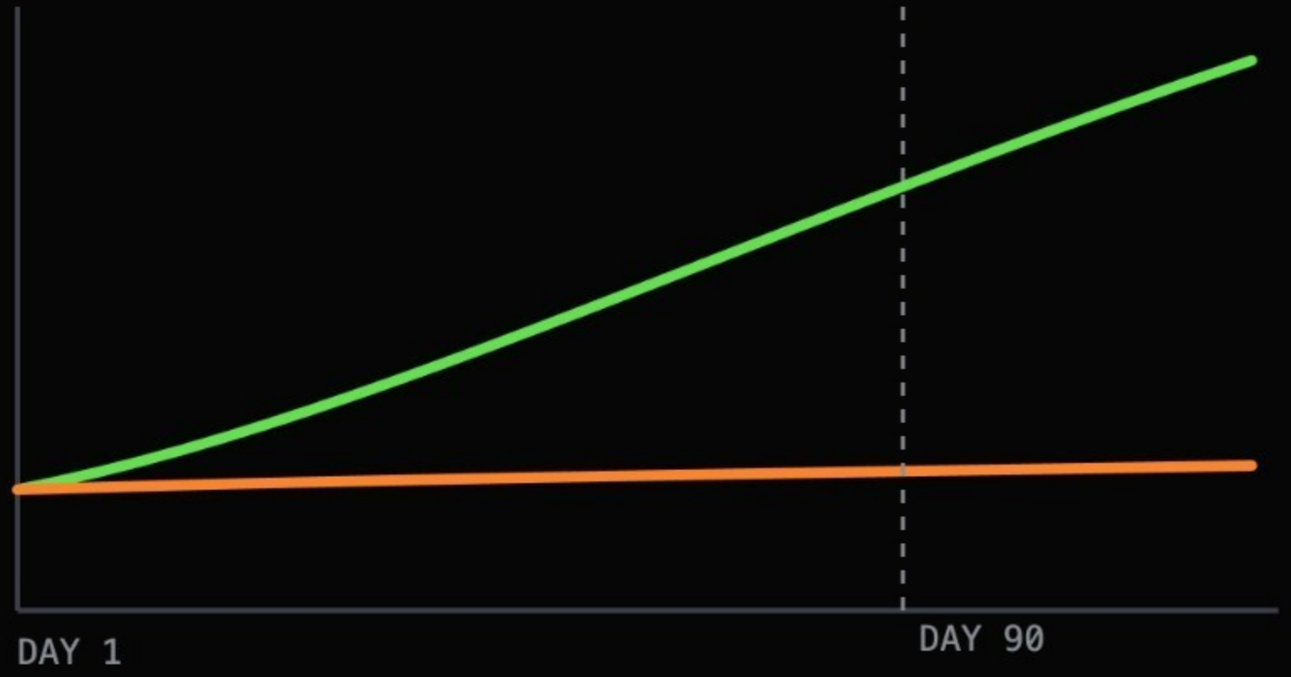


A B on paper can be opportunity and coaching, not ability.

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Grit + intelligence: watch the slope.



A PLAYER

Adjusts fast.

B PLAYER

Never pushed themselves. No change by day 90.

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[SO HOW DO WE RUN IT?]

Candidates see the process.
But they judge the culture.

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Startup vibes.

MOVE SLOW, THEN FAST



"Where are you in **YOUR** process?"

MISSIONARY ZEEL



"What do you need to commit?"

NO PRESSURE SELLING



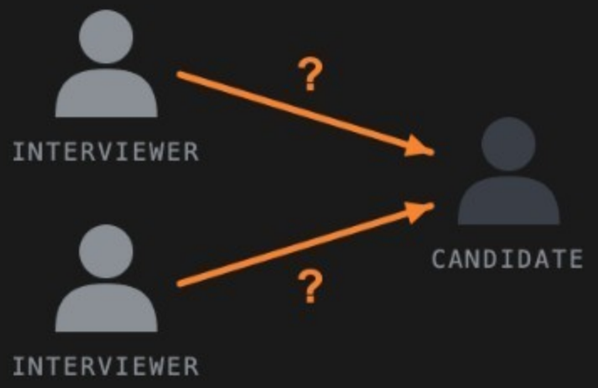
"This is an important decision for you — and us. Take the weekend and let us know Monday."

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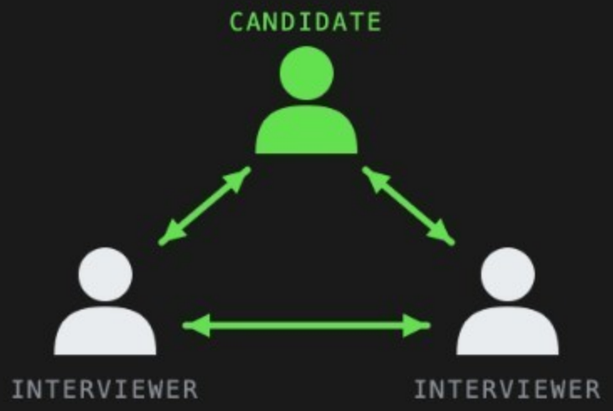
Two people.
A conversation, not a grilling.

GRILLING



Questions fired one way.

CONVERSATION



Ideas flow every direction.

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A growth factory, from the first call.

01 · FIRST CALL	Recruiter	“Where do you want to grow?”
02 · SCREEN	EM	“What's your next step?”
03 · ONSITE	Engineers	“Here's how you'd grow here.”
04 · TOPGRADING	EM	“Here is feedback on your performance.”

Every person they meet shows interest in their growth.

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[ONE LAST THING]

Be Gandalf

BILBO

Wanted his armchair. Gandalf saw the Took in him: a buried hunger for adventure.

THORIN & CO.

Wanted their mountain back. Gandalf gave the quest a plan, and a burglar.

ARAGORN

Wanted the crown, and Arwen. Gandalf stood by who he really was.

FRODO

Wanted to save the Shire. Gandalf showed him why it had to be him.

Meet each recruit's real motive — and know them better than they know themselves.

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